

The Industrial Revolution

Britain changed a lot in the 18th century. New machines were invented, and modern factories opened for the first time, making cloth and other goods in huge amounts. People moved from the countryside to perform factory work in smoky new towns. This period was called the Industrial Revolution.



Newcastle upon Tyne, 1877

Industrial towns
New towns sprang up across Britain, housing thousands of workers. Many houses were built back-to-back, with no outside space. Diseases spread quickly in the cramped streets, and living conditions were very bad.



Cotton-factory workers

Factories

Factories were built to contain new machines. Many of the factories made cloth. People who used to make cloth in their own homes now worked long hours inside busy, noisy factories instead.